

CONFLICT OF INTEREST (COI) POLICY

INSTITUTE FOR SUSTAINABLE SOCIOECONOMIC TRANSFORMATION OF AFRICA (ISSTA)



Institute for Sustainable Socioeconomic Transformation of Africa (ISSTA)
P.O.Box 189587 Kampala/ P.O.Box 57 Lira
East Africa, Uganda
Tel: +256777725444
E-mail dredward@isstaug.org/isstaceo780@gmail.com
<https://isstaug.org>

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ISSTA Organogram

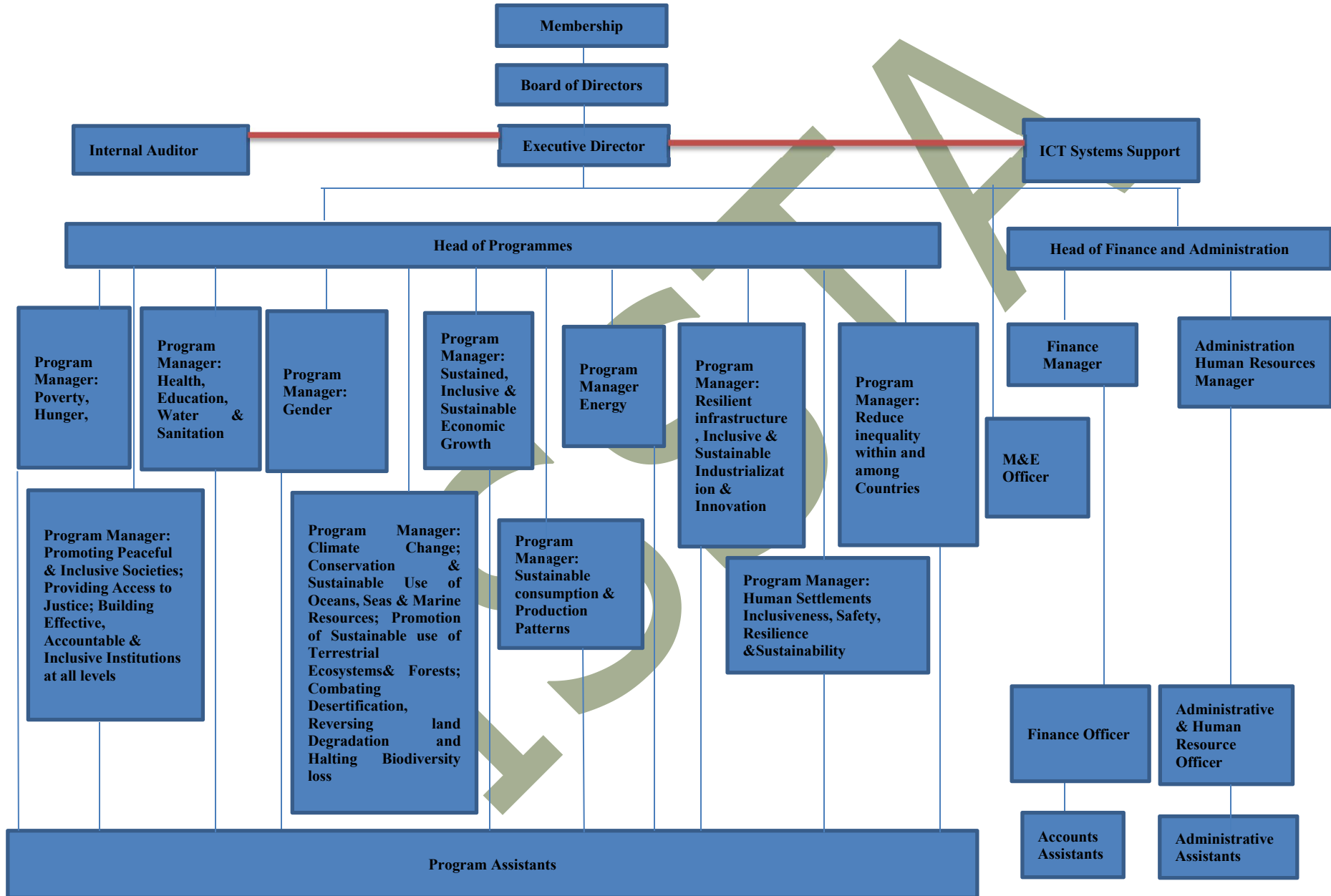


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1.0 BACKGROUND

ISSTA has a mission to make contributions to social development and as such, promotes inclusive growth through facilitating small holder farmers (SHFs) to mobilize themselves into feasible grassroots socioeconomic structures, mainly Cooperatives and Village Savings and Loans Associations (VSLAs), under specific value chains, producing and marketing food and tradable products like grain, cocoa, coffee, fish, fruits, and natural ingredients for cosmetics and pharmaceuticals. This approach has proven useful for poverty eradication, Food and Nutrition Security (FNS), and transforming SHFs' mindsets from subsistence to focused commercial activity. ISSTA also works to improve the target group's operating environment by building civic engagement capacities, which impact service delivery, sustainable environment resource use, democratic practice, human rights, peace, and justice.

2.0 PURPOSE

ISSTA's Purpose is to localise sustainable development in all its facets, through the identification of socioeconomic problems and stakeholders' participatory design and implementation of interventions that ensure inclusive growth amongst grassroots communities in Uganda, and across Africa

3.0 ISSTA KEY OBJECTIVE

To catalyse social development with inclusive growth by mobilising smallholder farmers, cooperatives, and MSMEs, to engage in market-focused value chains and promote agribusiness, food and nutrition security, sustainable environmental use, and civic engagement

4.0 ISSTA SPECIFIC OBJECTIVES

- (i) To mobilise smallholder farmers (SHFs) in the formation of cooperatives for competitive agribusiness, with women, youth, and deprived persons' inclusion and engaging in participatorily selected feasible value chains
- (ii) To mainstream food and nutrition security, and prudent environmental resources use through the promotion of sustainable and conservation agriculture among target groups activity
- (iii) To build community-based capacities in engaging duty bearers towards the promotion of service delivery, human rights, peace, and justice

5.0 ISSTA TARGET GROUP

ISSTA works with development stakeholders who include grassroots communities, funders from all countries of the world, regional development blocks, central governments, local governments, academia, faith-based organisations, International and National NGOs, and

6.0 CONFLICT OF INTEREST POLICY FRAMEWORK

6.1 Purpose

The primary purpose of this policy is to protect the integrity of ISSTA decision-making processes and ensure that all decisions are made in the best interest of the African communities it serves. It aims to prevent personal or financial interests from influencing professional judgment.

6.2 Scope

This policy applies to:

Board Members and Directors.

Staff and Employees (including the CEO and Management).

Volunteers and Field Facilitators working with VSLAs and cooperatives.

Contractors and Consultants representing ISSTA.

6.3 Definitions of Conflict

Actual Conflict: A situation where a person's private interests directly interfere with their duties (e.g., awarding a procurement contract to a family member).

Potential Conflict: A situation that could lead to a conflict in the future.

Perceived Conflict: A situation that may appear to be a conflict to an outside observer, which can still damage the organization's reputation.

6.4 Disclosure Procedures

Annual Declaration: All members must submit a signed Declaration of Interest form every year, even if no conflict exists.

Immediate Disclosure: If a conflict arises during a meeting or project (such as a new agricultural value chain partnership), the individual must disclose it immediately to their line manager or the Board.

Gifts and Hospitality: Employees are generally prohibited from accepting gifts that exceed a minor token value (often defined by a specific threshold, like 100,000 UGX) from stakeholders or vendors.

6.5 Management of Conflicts

Once a conflict is disclosed, the following actions may be taken:

Recusal: The individual is removed from any discussion, voting, or decision-making regarding the matter.

Monitoring: The person continues their work but under oversight to ensure no bias occurs.

Divestment: In extreme cases, the individual may be asked to end the outside interest that causes the conflict.

6.6 Consequences of Non-Compliance

Failure to disclose a known conflict is considered a breach of the ISSTA Code of Conduct and may result in disciplinary action, including termination or removal from the Board.

ISSTA